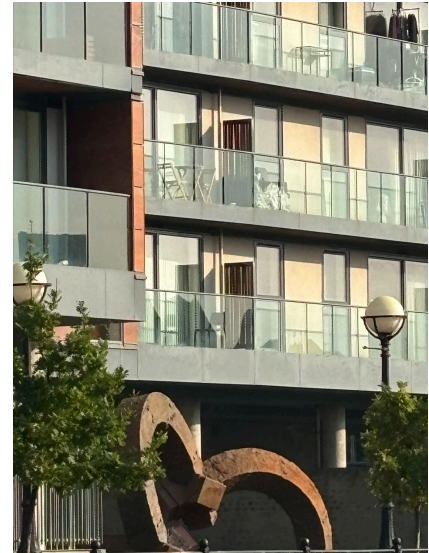


# Creative play

## Week 1

In week 1 the aim for our task was to explore the areas of media city to get a better understanding of our surroundings. The task was to develop a playful set of rules that will help us navigate around media city exploring things that we have not yet seen and then observe the areas for 2 minutes at a time then move. The goal of this task was to attempt to translate the information you felt or experienced on your exploration and think about what can be made into an immersive/ interactive story or game. With the information me and my team picked up around media city exploring the monuments and buildings we came to the conclusion that an escape game through media city would be a good fit for exploration of the city, information about the history of the city and overall entertainment whilst learning through the process of the game. To ensure that our board game would be entertaining and also educational we needed to research the historical facts about media city in a way that they were engaging and interesting to add to a board game that would equally be enjoyable to play for our users. In the task our rules that we set were to take two lefts and two rights to ensure that we were discovering the area of media city in a random way and stumbling upon places that we haven't seen before. Through the research we got, me and my team created a Psychogeography Map of the places we visited to give ourselves an idea of the immersive/interactive board game that we could create using these small landmarks.



## Week 2

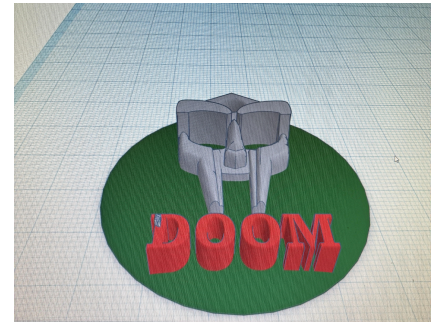
In week 2 is when the research from our notes of exploring media city came into place. My job as part of the team was to gain information about the history of the city and to research back to 1887 as to when media city started to be built. To do this i used a website named "<https://www.mediacityuk.co.uk/about-us/history/>" this website was very useful in gaining the information that was needed for my team as it showed images of when the city was built all the way up until the present day. One thing me and my team were focused on was providing the players of our board game with educational information about media city and this was done through this website giving facts from 1887 to 2024. As a team we had to come together to select a specific topic of what we wanted to tackle through our board game and this was educating the youth (and adults) about the city in which they see everyday however giving historical facts they may not know about the city they walk through. We then had to devise a set of



Game rules, objectives, components and player dynamics for our game to overall make it somewhat entertaining as well as educational whilst also factoring in game mechanics, strategies and story telling narrative to fit into the game design. With this we brain stormed ideas in a notebook of ways we could add all of the information that we have created into a fun game that keeps players playing it so we decided on a board game in which you have to escape media city while getting past each historical part of the city from 1887 to the present day (2024).

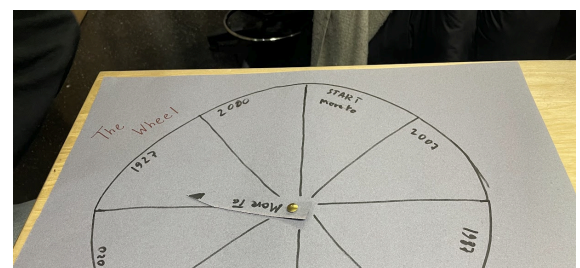
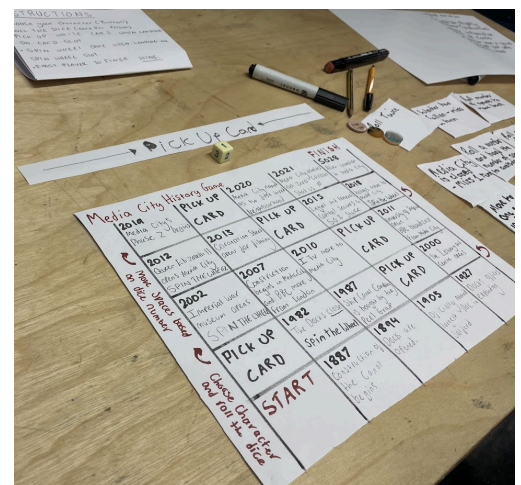
## Week 3

To begin week 3 we had an introduction to 3D printing and immersive stories. We each had an individual task to create a 3D printable object using a software called tinkercad. The requirements were that its printed volume should not exceed 5 cm wide / 5 cm deep / 5 cm high so i needed to use a grid for precise measurement. For my 3D model i decided to print off a replica of MF DOOM's mask, the reason that i decided to do this was to relate media city to its history of music and pop culture genre. The whole creation took around 2.5 hours to make in tinkercad which was shown to be an extremely useful and intuitive software for 3D modeling .the image shown on the right is what i created, i used different colouring to depict the artists colour theme and also made at the top of the mask a small hole so that the 3D print could be used as a keychain. I found this creation hard but also challenging in a good way and it was useful to know so that if my team needed board game pieces this would be one useful way to create them and also personalise them into whatever we wanted to in order so that it would fit to the ideologies of our board game. Through the process of creating this piece me and my team spoke and thought that the designs of small 3D printed objects could be useful in the entertainment of our game like in monopoly when everybody wanted to play with the car in the game or the cruise ship >.



## Week 4

In week 4 of the creation of our immersive/ interactive board game our task was to create an exhibit or exhibition piece that utilises the immersive storytelling and games workshop skills you will be introduced to at the start of the module. In our group of 4 we needed to create a playable game that ties in with our research into media city and its occupants or history while still considering the audience engagement. The final team output had to allow for some form of playful engagement by the audience of our choice in which we chose to target an audience of children aged 5 and above to adults of any age. Another thing that the final team output needed was something that reflects, explores, or analyses the present or history of Media City and its human and/or nonhuman inhabitants which is why as a team we decided to not only create an





entertaining game but also an informative game too, just like BBC's mission statement "inform, educate and entertain" do progress this further not only did we research about the past history but also the present with information like that MediaCity named as the first Wired Certified Neighbourhood in Europe and MediaCity's buildings become the first in the UK to achieve net zero carbon status. To begin completing the replica board game that we wanted to make we started with some simple paper and cardboard with the simple idea of rolling a dice and having figures like snakes and ladders and as you work your way up media city through the past to the present you find out about different facts in which place you land on as shown to the right. Also seen in the image below that is the make shift wheel we created to spin as you pick up a card when you land on a certain place in the game

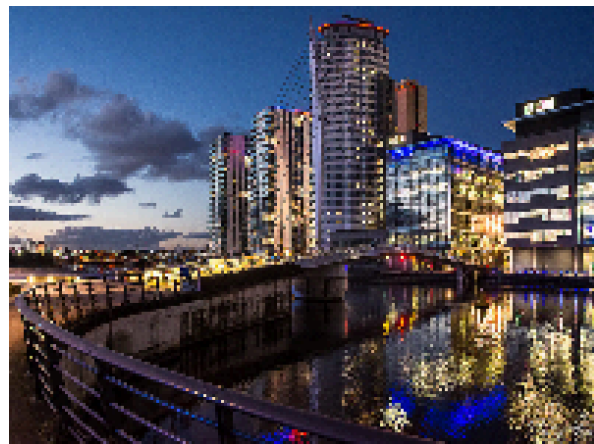
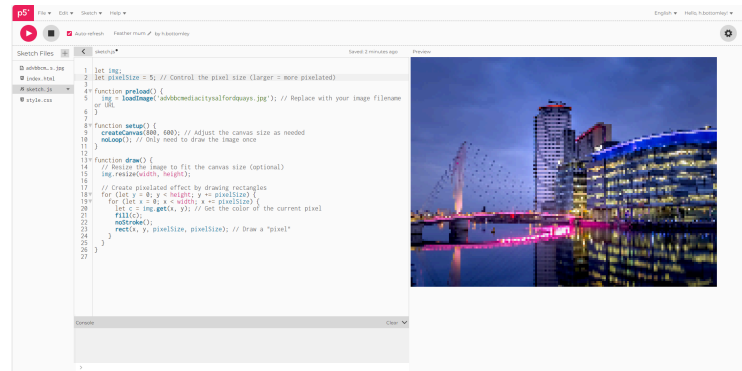
## Week 5

To begin week 5 we were introduced to a software called twine and Scanniverse. Scanniverse is a 3D scanning application that will enable users to capture highly detailed 3D models of objects, scenes, or environments using their smartphone. Advanced photogrammetry and Gaussian splatting techniques are used to create quality 3D representations. Users will be able to edit the models, view them in AR, and export the models for use in other applications, such as 3D printing or inclusion in other 3D projects. It does data processing locally in your device for privacy and can be shared on platforms like Niantic Studio to create extended reality. Overall Scanniverse is a smaller app to create 3D photogrammetry which is just the process of generating virtual models in three dimensions by stitching together numerous pictures taken at varied angles or distances on the same object or its surroundings. Moving on to Twine, Twine is a software application that is a free tool used to make interactive, nonlinear stories and games, mostly as hypertext. It is very popular with writers, game designers, and teachers who want to create branching stories or choose-your-own-adventure projects without needing a lot of programming skills. As me and my group used Twine we decided that this was the best fit for us, in our group we had levels of coding experience and art making which would be a perfect fit for what we wanted to create. As me and my team got more used to twine we discovered the things that were capable with it and made our move to use twine as a storytelling narrative instead of a traditional board game as we also wanted to make the game more interactive.



## Week 6

To start week 6 me and my team began to work with twine, practicing with the techniques of adding in images, adding sounds and GIF's etc. As our knowledge of Twine began to grow as a team we decided to make notes of how we could use our research from our previous board game to transfer over to our new discovery of twine. We came up with the decision to make an escape from the media city game through twine, however we are also educating our audience on the exploration of media city and the things that you can do there in the present day. My job as part of our team was to create some of the art work for the group project. As a collective we decided that we wanted to go with the pixel art theme for our project and to link this directly with media city I decided to create some code in P5.js that turned the image I added into it into a pixelated version as shown in these images. The images that I made using the p5.js code were used in the background images for our twine game to ensure that our users knew what relatability our immersive story would have to our game. Along with a well detailed narrative of the play through of our game as the art creator i also wanted to make these images in pixel art form to show the direct link to media city and what our game is fully about .

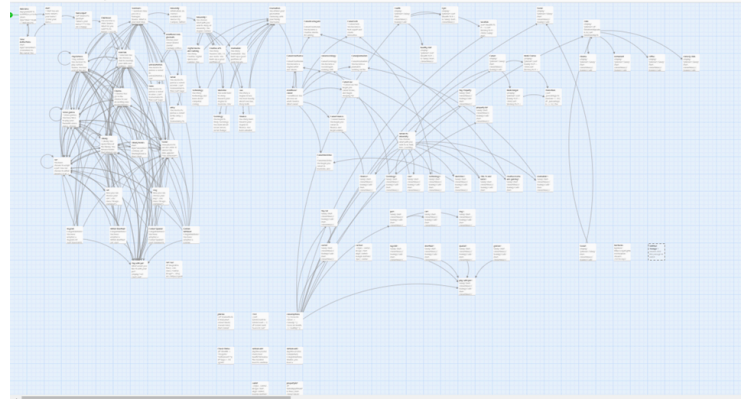


## Week 7

Week 7 revolved around finalising the overall ideas and exiting the beta phase of our twine story and evidently moving into something that can be playable and playtested by other teams in the next week for week 8. With this our group had a meeting and came to the conclusion that we would like to make a "bit life" version of media city in which the goal is to go through media city and grow up from age 1 to however high you can get whilst going through life as a child to university to getting a job and buying cars and houses. We thought that this would be challenging coding wise and also challenging story wise however we wanted to give ourselves that challenge and take it on to create something that we were all proud of. Again as part of the art side to the project i searched the internet to find different audio files in which could be embedded into our game as either background noise, audio for clicking, audio for money, and audio for finishing the game etc. we found the importing of the audio files tricky and hard to get around as it took us a while to figure out the mechanics and code to import this into our game however we managed to get it done after some help and



dedication. Another one of my jobs as a part of the team was to make the passages from the twine project look neat and tidy so that they were accessible to edit for another team member Daniel who was coding the project, as you can see on the right the passages look unordered and messy however this is after i have ordered them into a particular way to ensure that the passages are easy to understand and see when editing the code or trying to find a particular passage. **94 passages**



## Week 8

This week was much more important than all the weeks before because it was the official playtest week. It was the time when other teams would try our game and give us helpful feedback and advice. While it was good to look at and learn from other groups' games during the module-getting ideas, finding useful methods, and seeing different ways of thinking-this week had its own special pressure. Most of the time was spent on serious, last-minute preparations, fixing problems, and making final changes before the playtesting. After all the work, the last hour was for other teams to play our game and give their detailed feedback. Even though our game was still in early development, the playtest was surprisingly successful. By then, our team had put up the main structure of the game, and most of the feedback received was helpful. The major criticism was that the game needed simplification to fit into the careers and education theme of Media City, as we had deviated slightly from the initial plans. Too much information in the interactive story, said many; extra clicks make people not enjoy it as much as they would. Due to this, we decided to take out some of the parts that were not directly related to the Media City framework. For instance, we eliminated any degrees and jobs unrelated to Media and those that lay outside the BBC or the Media sector since they didn't fit the theme we wanted to convey. This helped narrow down the game and keep it relevant to the educational objectives of the project. Once we made it simpler and removed what was unnecessary, we had a much cleaner and more focused version of the game.

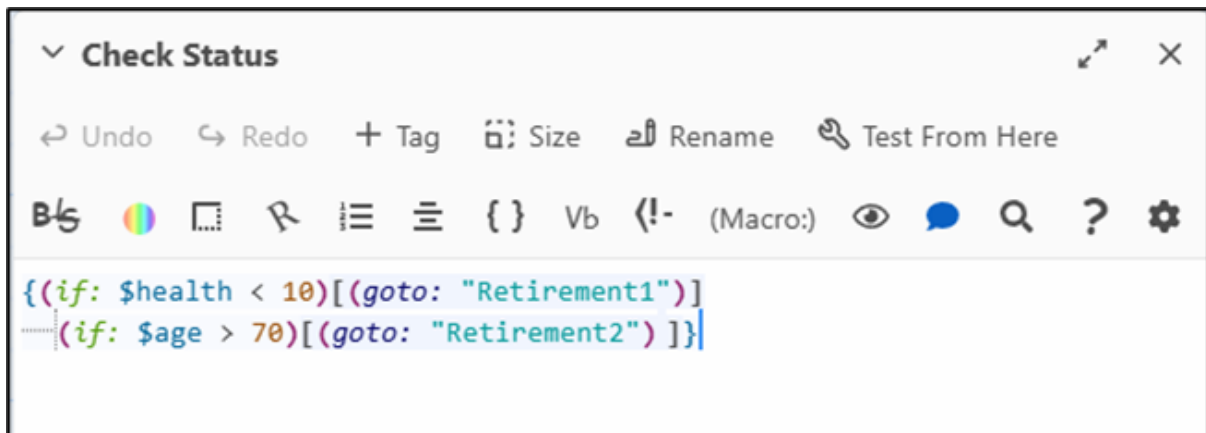
## Creative play group reflection

In order to effectively complete our group project we needed to split up each member of the team into different roles depending on their strengths. The group decided on 4 roles consisting of the idea of "Belbin's Team Roles". These specific roles included Resource investigator, Teamworker and Coordinator which is the "people" roll, then there is the Monitor evaluator, Specialist and plant for the "thinking" roll, and finally the implementer, complete finisher and shaper Being the "Action" member of the team. These roles were based on what

strengths each member of our team had. Daniels Strengths held in the action part of the team where he could effectively Shape our project, Implement it and finish it as a whole. Ben's strengths lie in the coordination of the group which allies with the "people" part of Belbin's team roles as he constructed the plan of what needed to be done and when. My strengths were held in the resource investigation and Monitor evaluator parts of Belbin's roles, these strengths helped the team to gain the correct information in which they needed to successfully complete the group project as a whole this role helped the team to see all possible options, anticipate problems, detect threats to the team early and judge accurately helping the team to avoid worst case scenarios Aarons skills were used to the Thinking, specialist and plant side of the given roles to overall problem solve when the team hit a dead end with the creative aspect that is needed. This collaborative approach was critical to achieving our goal of creating a polished Twine Interactive Story, underscoring the value of Belbin's Team Roles in fostering teamwork and efficiency. To talk about my contribution and thoughts throughout this project experience, I think my skills in my art work, efficiency of the game and overall creative output of ideas had significant importance due to the lack of guidance that was present during the first few weeks of group formation and information, personally without this team structure our Twine project would be scattered and incomplete. For example, after Aaron had completed his thinking skills/activities, I designated him with the role of creating a pitch to those who played our game in the week 8 playtest, providing information to the game. He also created an instruction document that could be implemented into the game's menu, to teach players how to play the Life Simulation before starting. Another example of me providing a dynamic team structure in the later process of our development was the re-assignment of my role (Resource Investigator and Monitor Evaluator), I shortly became a 'Completer Finisher' due to the fact Ben assigned me to collect last-minute visual resources for the documentation we were writing for this very module. He took more photos of Media city and recovered our previous boardgame to take more detailed photos of it for all our reflective documents. As a final solution to the game's ending, Daniel (Our Completer Finisher) added a function where once the Simulation reaches 70 years old, it takes the player to the ending screen, hence completing / ending the playthrough. In conclusion, after several weeks of preparation, and multiple weeks of development the Interactive, Life Simulation game 'Simulation Theory' is complete.

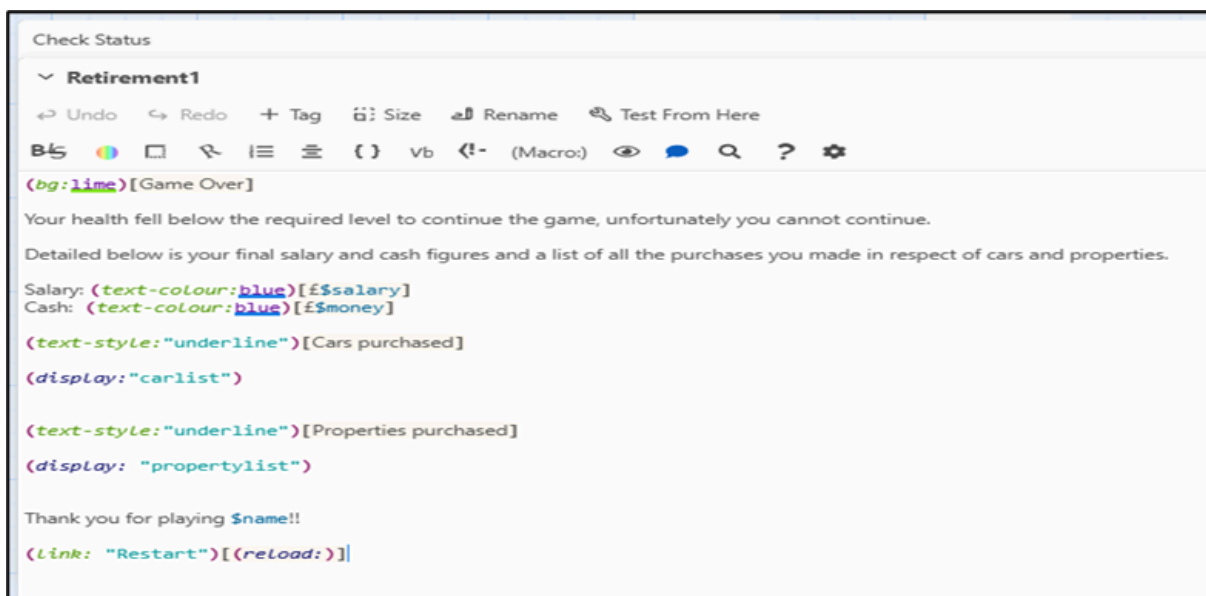
End game code added...

If your health reaches below 10 or if your age reaches 70



```
▼ Check Status
↶ Undo ↷ Redo + Tag ⚙ Size 📁 Rename 🔍 Test From Here
B I U ☑ 🔍 { } Vb <!-- (Macro:) 👁 💬 🔍 ? ⚙
{(if: $health < 10)[(goto: "Retirement1")]
...{(if: $age > 70)[(goto: "Retirement2") ]}}
```

Game Over (if health reaches below 10), shows list of purchases and option to restart/reset



```
Check Status
▼ Retirement1
↶ Undo ↷ Redo + Tag ⚙ Size 📁 Rename 🔍 Test From Here
B I U ☑ 🔍 { } Vb <!-- (Macro:) 👁 💬 🔍 ? ⚙
(bg: lime)[Game Over]

Your health fell below the required level to continue the game, unfortunately you cannot continue.

Detailed below is your final salary and cash figures and a list of all the purchases you made in respect of cars and properties.

Salary: (text-colour: blue)[f$salary]
Cash: (text-colour: blue)[f$money]

(text-style: "underline")[Cars purchased]
(display: "carlist")

(text-style: "underline")[Properties purchased]
(display: "propertylist")

Thank you for playing $name!!

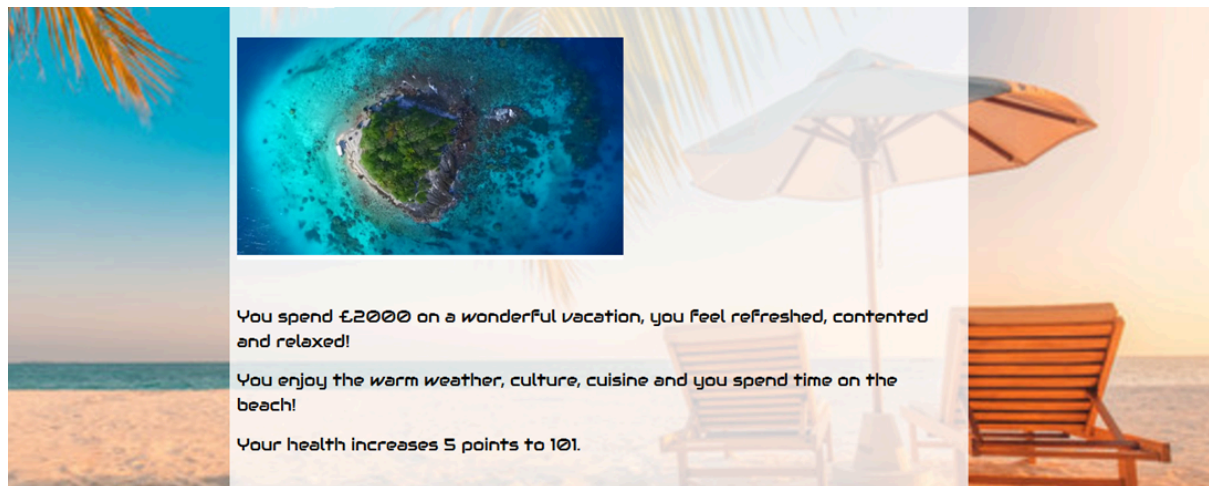
(Link: "Restart")[(reload:)]
```



Game completed (if age reaches 70 ), shows list of purchases and option to restart/reset

```
Retirement2
Undo Redo + Tag Size Rename Test From Here
B&S [Icons] { } Vb <- (Macro:) [Icons] ? [Settings]
(bg:lime)[Game Completed]
Congratulations $name, you lived a successful life and successfully completed the game by reaching retirement.
Detailed below is your final salary and cash figures and a list of all the purchases you made in respect of cars and properties.
Salary: (text-colour:blue)[£$salary]
Cash: (text-colour:blue)[£$money]
(text-style:"underline")[Cars purchased]
(display:"carlist")
(text-style:"underline")[Properties purchased]
(display: "propertylist")
Thank you for playing $name!!
(Link: "Restart")[(reload:)]
```

Vacation page with autoplay feature on YouTube video



**Code for vacation (\$money decreases by 2000, health increases by 5 )**

```

Vacation
Undo Redo + Tag Size Rename Test From Here
B& # Color Fill Stroke Size Font Family Font Size Bold Italic Underline Link Unlink Macro View Search Help
vacation
{{set: $health to it + 5}}
{{set: $money to it - 2000}}
Salary: (text-colour:blue)[$salary]
Cash: (text-colour:blue)[$money]
Age: (text-colour:blue)[$age]
Health: (text-colour:blue)[$health]

[<iframe width="560" height="315" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/1YvdAZ9LHik?autoplay=1" frameborder="0" allow="autoplay; encrypted-media" allowfullscreen></iframe>]

You spend £2000 on a wonderful vacation, you feel refreshed, contented and relaxed!
You enjoy the warm weather, culture, cuisine and you spend time on the beach!
Your health increases 5 points to $health.

```

**options for childhood and adulthood**

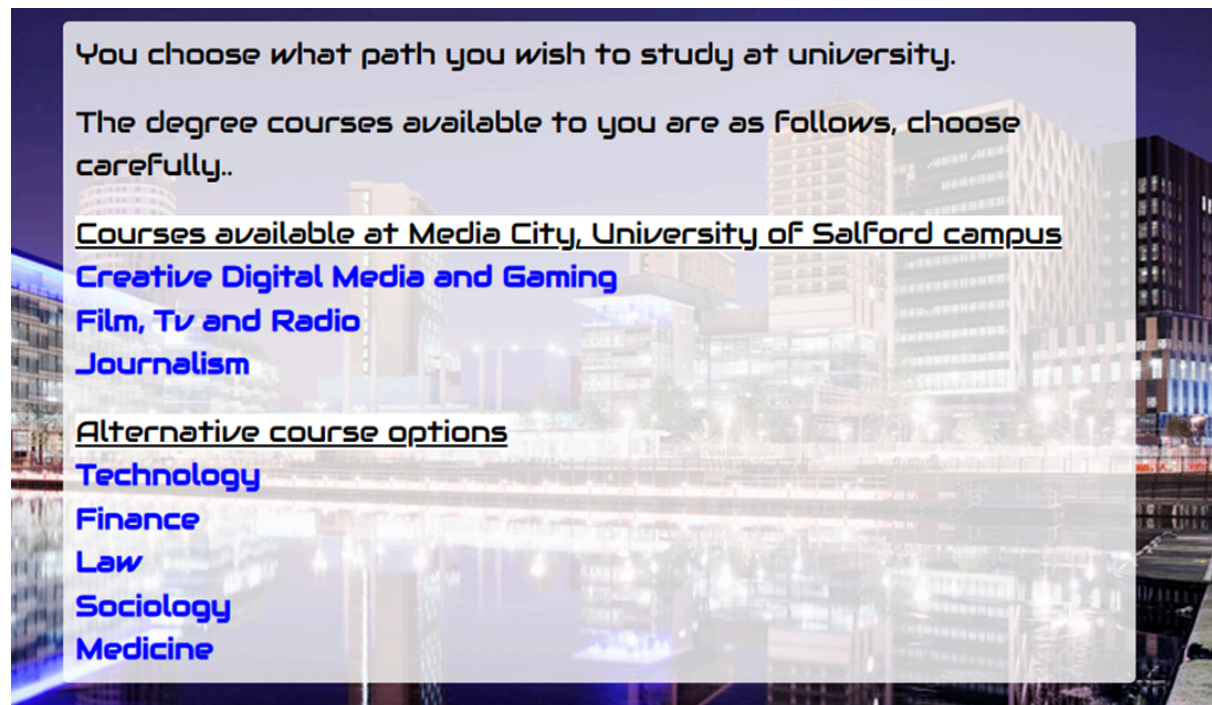
Your options are....

- Go to the cinema
- Play video games
- Go to the library
- Play outside
- Join a club
- Restaurants in Media City
- Adopt a new pet

Your options are

- Focus on career
- Focus on health
- Restaurants in Media City
- Go on vacation
- Dating Game
- Adopt a new pet
- Buy a car
- Buy Property

## Degree options tailored to Media City campus



## Image of Peel Park (play outside) updated image taken on smartphone



## More cars added to purchase



## More properties added to purchase

